

Tanmay Padekar

Product Designer • HCI Researcher • Inclusive Design
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PROFILE

UX Designer with 3+ years of experience across web and mobile, currently completing an M.S. in Human-Computer Interaction at RIT (GPA 3.7). Designs with research at the core from usability testing and user interviews through to high-fidelity prototypes and developer handoff. My capstone project applies AI and inclusive design principles for neurodivergent and ESL learners, backed by an IRB-approved Delphi study. Thrives in collaborative teams and brings clarity to ambiguous problems.

EXPERIENCE

UX Researcher & Usability Analyst | Excellus Foundation (Lifetime Benefit Solutions) | Jan 2025 – May 2025 • Rochester, NY

- Led a 5-task summative usability study with 8 participants using think-aloud protocol on an employee-facing HSA portal uncovered 9+ navigation errors on the most complex task alone with task completion times varying up to 3x between users, revealing critical information architecture inconsistencies.
- Identified that 100% of participants expected live chat support (unprompted) and that HSA content was fragmented across 4+ sections with no clear entry point, causing cognitive overload and repeated backtracking for first-time users.
- Synthesized quantitative error data and Likert-scale satisfaction scores into a 25-page usability report with a prioritized redesign roadmap recommending a centralized HSA Hub, clearer content labeling, and Live Chat integration.

UI/UX Designer & Researcher | Antriksh Global | May 2022 – Jul 2024 • Pune, India

- Designed web and mobile apps, dashboards, and interfaces for 20+ products across B2B, consumer e-commerce, logistics, and education delivering end-to-end UX across 10+ clients from research and wireframes through to high-fidelity prototypes and developer handoff.
- Built a reusable Figma component library and design system from scratch, reducing average design-to-handoff time by 25% across repeat client engagements and standardizing UI patterns across all active projects.
- Contributed to a 30% increase in repeat client engagements by delivering consistent, on-brand UI systems and maintaining style guides adopted across all active projects.
- Ran usability testing and competitive analysis across 8+ product cycles, translating findings into interaction flow improvements that directly addressed user drop-off points identified in stakeholder reviews.

UI/UX Design Intern | Antriksh Global | Aug 2021 – May 2022 • Pune, India

- Designed sitemaps, wireframes, and high-fidelity prototypes across 5+ client projects in under 10 months, consistently delivering within sprint timelines while iterating based on stakeholder feedback across 2–3 review cycles per project.
- Designed accessible e-learning modules for the European Institute of Purchasing Management applied WCAG accessibility standards and responsive grid systems, improving content structure across 4+ course modules.

EDUCATION

M.S. Human-Computer Interaction | Rochester Institute of Technology | Aug 2024 – Dec 2026 • GPA: 3.7

Coursework: Usability Testing, User-Centered Design Methods, Research Methods, Information & Interaction Design

B.E. Information Technology | Savitribai Phule Pune University | Jul 2019 – May 2023 • GPA: 3.9

PROJECTS

The Affective Loop | Master's Capstone — RIT | 2025–26

- Designing an AI-driven system for student academic wellness focused on real-time affective feedback and long-term stress data reflection, with inclusive design for neurodivergent and ESL learners.
- Running an IRB-approved Delphi study with 10–12 participants across 3 iterative survey rounds, evaluating mid-to-high fidelity prototypes and building consensus on inclusive design guidelines.
- Deliverables include interactive prototypes, UI mockups, and scalable inclusive design guidelines for AI-powered educational tools.

MyCourses Redesign | Academic Project — RIT

- Redesigned RIT's course management submission flow — collapsed a 4-screen process into a single context-aware interface, reducing task completion time by 1.75x and improving clarity scores by 91% in usability testing.
- Process: user research, affinity mapping, interaction flow redesign, iterative Figma prototyping with micro-interactions, and usability validation.

SKILLS

Design & Prototyping: Figma, Adobe XD, Illustrator, Photoshop, InDesign, Sketch, InVision, Framer, Balsamiq

AI & Emerging Tools: Figma AI, Galileo AI, Midjourney, Spline, Lottie, ChatGPT (research synthesis)

Research Methods: Usability Testing, Delphi Method, User Interviews, Affinity Mapping, Competitive Analysis, Contextual Inquiries, Survey Design, IRB Protocol

Web & Collaboration: HTML5, CSS3/SCSS, JavaScript, Responsive Design, WCAG Accessibility, Zeplin, Jira, Notion, Miro